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SMELLS LIKE TEAM SPIRIT

Even as icons stepped away, Indian men's cricket revealed a depth that kept wins flowing across formats. But the defining triumph came from its women

For fans, Virat Kohli and Rohit Sharma's quiet exit from Test cricket in May 2025 signalled the end of an era. Yet before the year was out, the two were once again scripting victories for India, climbing to the top of the ODI batting rankings. Only the stage grew smaller; the fire remained.

To understand how India arrived here, one must return to the years when Kohli's batting pushed at the edges of possibility first set by first deity Sachin Tendulkar, while Rohit glided through tournaments—peaking at the 2019 World Cup, where he unfurled five immaculate hundreds. But behind the silver linings were some clouds too: the humbling loss to Pakistan in the 2017 Champions Trophy final, and the 2019 WC semi-final where M.S. Dhoni's run-out felt like a curtain falling—not just on a chase, but on a certainty that had defined a generation.